

BRAINSTORMING & IDEATION

Standard Laptop Procurement Automation using ServiceNow Flow Designer

Project Document – 01

1. Problem Statement

The existing IT procurement process for standard laptops involves several manual steps, including placing a service catalog request, obtaining approval, and creating or assigning a task to the hardware team for laptop configuration. When these activities are handled manually, configuration tasks may be delayed or overlooked after a request is approved. This can increase the waiting time for users and create unnecessary administrative work for the IT procurement team.

The project addresses this issue by introducing an automated workflow in ServiceNow. When a standard laptop request is approved, the system automatically creates a Catalog Task with the required configuration description and assigns it to the Hardware group. This provides a consistent and traceable process from approval to configuration.

2. Project Idea

The main idea is to use ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate the post-approval activity for Standard Laptop service requests. Instead of depending on an IT employee to manually create a configuration task, the Flow Designer will generate the task automatically after the service request reaches the required approval stage.

The proposed flow creates a Catalog Task for the requested item, updates the short description to indicate that the laptop needs configuration, sets the description, assigns the task to the Hardware assignment group, and records the approval status as Approved. This makes the workflow easier to track and reduces the possibility of human error.

3. User Story

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that configuration tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team after approval. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reduce user waiting time, and minimize manual intervention.

4. Project Objectives

- Create a seamless process for users requesting a Standard Laptop through the Service Catalog.
- Automatically generate a Catalog Task after the service request is approved.
- Assign the generated configuration task to the Hardware team.
- Reduce manual intervention and the possibility of missed or delayed configuration tasks.
- Improve resource utilization by routing tasks to the appropriate support group.

- Improve visibility and traceability of the laptop procurement and configuration process.
- Reduce user waiting time by initiating laptop configuration activities promptly.

5. Brainstorming and Proposed Solution

During the brainstorming stage, the main bottleneck identified was the transition from an approved laptop request to the actual hardware configuration activity. The following ideas were considered to improve the process:

Automatic task creation: Create a Catalog Task automatically when the Standard Laptop request reaches the approved stage.

Automatic assignment: Route the task directly to the Hardware assignment group instead of requiring manual assignment.

Standardized task information: Use a predefined short description and description so that the hardware team receives clear instructions.

Service Catalog integration: Connect the automation to the Standard Laptop catalog item so the workflow is specific to the required service.

Status tracking: Allow the procurement team to verify the generated Catalog Task from the Requested Item record.

6. Proposed Workflow

1. The user selects the Standard Laptop item from the Service Catalog.
2. The user places the laptop request using Order Now.
3. The service request and Requested Item are created in ServiceNow.
4. The request goes through the required approval process.
5. After approval, the configured Flow Designer automation is triggered.
6. The flow creates a Catalog Task for the Requested Item.
7. The task receives the short description and description: "Laptop need to Configured".
8. The Assignment Group is automatically set to Hardware.
9. The Hardware team can view and process the configuration task.
10. The procurement team can verify the generated task from the Requested Item record.

7. Expected Benefits

- Faster initiation of laptop configuration activities after approval.
- Reduced dependency on manual task creation and assignment.
- Lower risk of configuration tasks being forgotten or delayed.
- Consistent task information for the Hardware team.
- Better allocation of IT support resources.
- Improved visibility into the procurement workflow.
- Better overall user experience through reduced waiting time.

8. Initial Project Scope

The initial scope of the project is limited to automating the task creation and assignment process for the Standard Laptop service catalog item. The automation focuses on the workflow after approval and does not attempt to automate physical purchasing, vendor communication, inventory delivery, or hardware installation. These activities can be considered for future enhancements.

9. Conclusion

The brainstorming and ideation process identified manual task creation and assignment as important areas for improvement in the Standard Laptop procurement process. The proposed ServiceNow Flow Designer solution addresses this gap by automatically creating a Catalog Task and assigning it to the Hardware team after approval. The idea provides a clear foundation for developing a streamlined, consistent, and traceable laptop procurement workflow.